

Ubuntu is fairly standard, with a huge community supporting it, receives regular updates every six months, is stable enough for daily use, has the largest selection of software (including Steam games) and most importantly, focuses on ease of use above all else. Ubuntu has a lot of flavours that rebundle the 'stock' Ubuntu experience with a different user interface (including the popular Linux Mint), but they're all equivalent on a technical level. For the same reason, this installation guide will use Ubuntu as an example. If you have some experience with Linux, feel free to experiment with some of the more 'advanced' options out there like Arch Linux, Gentoo and Debian.

If you're not entirely sure about installing a new Operating System on your hard drive, or you don't want to void your manufacturer's warranty by partitioning your hard drive, you can always install it within a Virtual Machine. Both VirtualBox (<http://dgit.in/ftVirtualBox>) and VMWare (<http://dgit.in/ftVMWare>) allow you to run Linux as a Guest on either a Windows or an OS X host. The install process is nearly identical, with the obvious exception that you won't need to partition your hard drive or even create an installation disc. Skip to Step 2. if you intend on installing Linux in a Virtual Machine.

1. Prepare the install media

Download the latest release of Ubuntu, version 14.04, codenamed Trusty Tahr, from the website - <http://dgit.in/ftUbuntuDownload>. If your connection permits, download using the torrent file using a BitTorrent client - not only will you ease the load on Ubuntu's servers, but your download will probably finish faster. If your system supports 64 bit Operating Systems, download the

corresponding image, else go for the 32 bit version.

Once you have the ISO image, you'll need to either burn it to a CD/DVD or a USB drive. For the latter, use a program called Unetbootin (<http://dgit.in/ftUnetbootin>) available on both Mac and Windows, or Linux Live USB Creator (<http://dgit.in/>



Use Unetbootin to prepare a bootable Ubuntu flash drive.